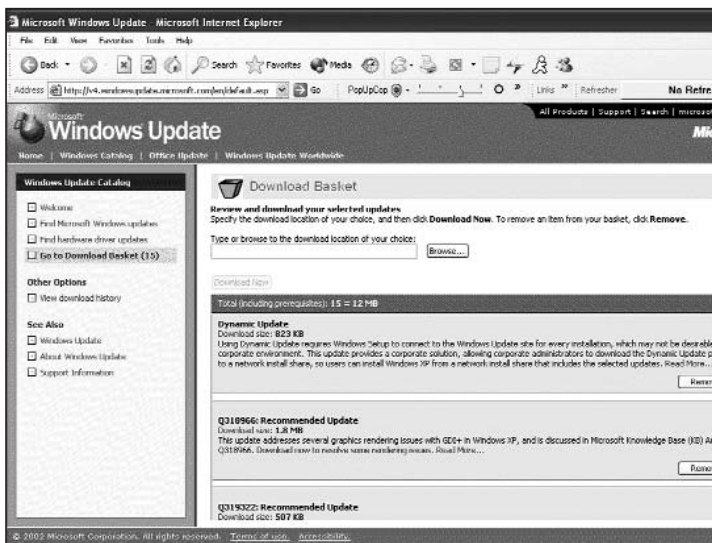


4.1 Patching For Security

The stark reality of life—all software must be patched at some time or another! No, this is not an exaggerated statement. No matter how perfect a software seems when it's released, people are bound to find bugs and security holes in the code. So, to fix these nig-



gling problems, software companies release patches on a regular basis. This really isn't a big deal for offline programs such as your CD burning utility or your image editor, but with any program that functions by connecting to the Internet—an e-mail client, a Web browser or even media players—patching is a priority.

So which software do you need to update? Ideally, you should update all drivers and programs that you use on a regular basis. Your top priority, however, is to keep your operating system updated with the latest patches. Luckily, newer Windows OSes such as Windows 2000 and windows XP, already come with a Windows Update utility that informs you of any new security fixes released for the OS. If you make updation a ritual, your computer will be bet